

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Adult hands-only CPR

MEDICAL / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

If an adult suddenly collapses, is unresponsive and is not breathing normally or is only gasping, call emergency services, get an AED and start chest compressions. Push hard and fast in the center of the chest at 100–120 compressions per minute; follow dispatcher instructions.

Do now.

**Check safely**

01

Ensure the scene is safe and check responsiveness and breathing quickly.

**Call and get an AED**

02

Use speakerphone or send someone to call and bring an AED.

**Give compressions**

03

Place both hands in the center of the chest; compress at least 2 inches, avoiding more than 2.4 inches, and allow full recoil.

**Continue**

04

Follow the AED prompts and dispatcher instructions until responders take over or normal signs of life return.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

If a call will not connect, start or continue compressions. Ask another person to keep trying and bring an AED. If alone, use speakerphone while starting CPR rather than waiting for an answer. Do not leave an unresponsive person just to seek better reception.

Watch for.

This adult sudden-collapse guide does not replace infant or child CPR instructions. Gasping is not normal breathing.

People & practical needs.

Give someone the specific task of calling or locating care while another person provides first aid. Keep the patient warm or cool as the condition requires and record what happened and when

Next decision.

Take a CPR course. Trained rescuers can give breaths according to training; children, infants, drowning and other breathing-related arrests need appropriate CPR with breaths.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Adult hands-only CPR · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/cpr/>